

Address Book, Windows Calendar, Windows Photo Gallery, Internet Explorer, and Windows Mail (formerly known as Outlook Express) on Windows Vista too? Even if it does, what about Windows XP, which has no default calendaring or photo management application built into it? It is a given that the iPhone will very easily and automatically synchronise all the media from iTunes (like the iPod) but if it is not just as efficient in synchronising the data on Windows computers, it will be a deal breaker for most people.

The screen

It has a beautiful, large screen that serves as its primary user interface. This means that people will have to play on that screen with their fingers all day long—and those fingers might be sweaty, oily, or have long nails. Will the iPhone be able to resist scratches and fingerprints? If you go by Apple's past record, that seems like a distinct impossibility. There have been a lot of complaints about the iPod nano being extremely prone to scratches. The MacBooks have also suffered from similar problems. Unless Apple has done some major improvements to the quality of their displays, potential iPhone customers might be deterred by what would surely be a very scratch-prone screen. What makes matters worse is that it is extremely likely that you cannot cover the iPhone's screen with any sort of protective screen because multi-touch technology apparently needs finger contact to function. A closer inspection of the demo unit Jobs was using onstage at the Macworld Expo reveals that it was covered with a lot of fingerprints. All in all, that is a dismal picture, unless there are going to be drastic improvements in the final shipping version (which is quite likely).

Single handed operation

A wide phone with a huge touchscreen will most certainly require the use of both hands at all times. So if you are travelling in a local train and have not managed a seat for yourself, you will either have to keep the phone in your pocket or risk being shoved by someone into another person while you use both your hands on the phone. However, this is only a perceived drawback in our opin-